

Trembling Matter

Cloth as a Bodily Vessel for Speculative Landscapes

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Cover front and back: Agave leaves in Marseille (Gösta von Platen, 2025).



Image 1. Graph from sketchbook journal (Gösta von Platen, 2024).

Abstract

The aim of this paper is to cultivate an artistic practice allowing for a more attentive relationship to the physical matter of one's immediate surroundings. Situated at the intersection of urban environments and nature, the project investigates how the human and the more-than-human are continuously interwoven. Through extensive fieldwork in Paris's *18ème Arrondissement* in France and *Hållsviken* bay in Sweden, image-making and material processes are explored as methods for sensing and relating to space. By treating found materials as active participants rather than passive supports, the making of pigments, textures, and structures becomes a form of speculative landscaping. Textile theory acts as a conceptual framework, while post-humanism and phenomenology support the argumentation to better understand embodied and relational experiences. The study of a Renaissance tapestry at the Louvre's collections, in dialogue with two older historical textiles, connects material practices of the past and present, situating the project within current dilemmas of climate change, consumption and technology. These works connect material practices of the past and present, situating the project within current dilemmas of climate change, consumption and technology. Poetic references of literature becomes tools to further reflect on human agency, and our malfunctioning relationship to the environment in contemporary Western culture. Finally, the project proposes spatial textile-based installations, constructed as portable and reconfigurable structures, as a way to engage singular moments in spontaneous and immersive spaces.

Key words

Materialism, Post-humanism, Anthropocene, Environment, Tapestry, Textile, Painting, Printing, Nature, Urbanism

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a visual reportage

människokropp

Our bodies nos Corps

Falling Resting Aching Gaping

Dunkelt

peut-être c’est juste un autre truc

holding me through this thunder

Du där, where to?

notre Corps

Falling Resting Aching Gaping

Who is the beast

Searching the wastes

grönskan vajar stilla vart vi än vänder oss

Vänta lite till then we leave follow me still

Sure you are

le chemin ne mène pas ailleurs que là

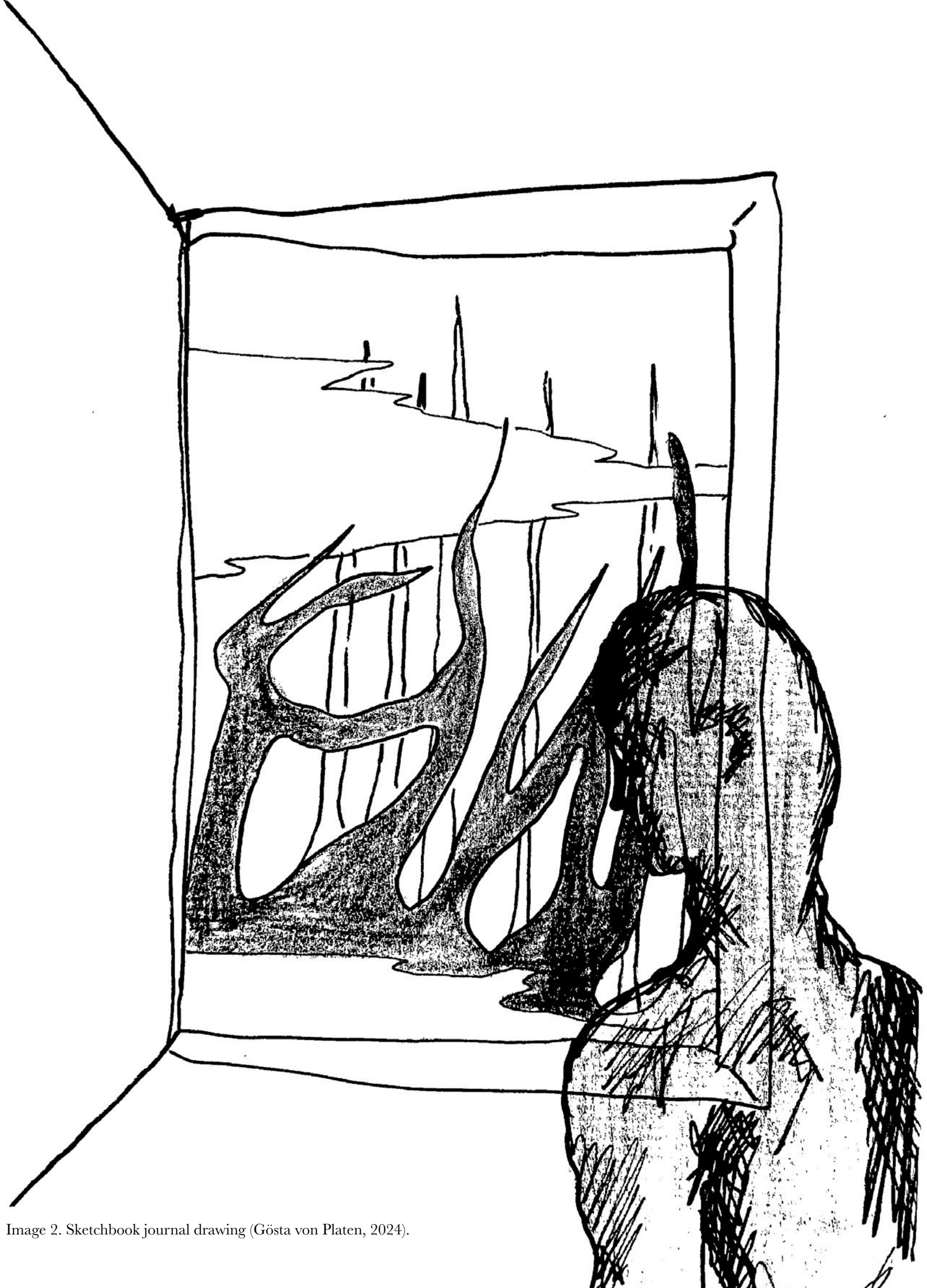


Image 2. Sketchbook journal drawing (Gösta von Platen, 2024).

Hold me safe while the world is trembling

Introduction

As a shimmering bug, drawn to a molten tree trunk, I circle back to places dear to me, only to flee due to the distress they cause in the instant. My escape follows a path, along the shores of the Baltic Sea, all the way back to the train tracks entering Paris, terminus *Gare du Nord.* I am searching for something that speaks to me; is the earth by my feet unaware of my presence, or rather me, unaware of its true nature? It is a process of revisiting places and materials that once felt familiar, exerting an unsettling pull, only to recognise how time and decay reshape my response. This movement forms the ground for my speculative making, in which I examine how humans inhabit, and are continually shaped by the material world.

One can argue, that the starting point for this project was outside of my own control, as an artist, a designer and a human, due to the environment's power over my own actions. A force that has its roots in my own anxiety for the future, or rather the continuous materialisation of our being. The more one learns about the influence of global, technological and capitalist systems, the less it seems they have been successful in shifting the direction we are heading in. Instead, the values of art, of making material and non-material works, seems to be integrated with the ones of capitalism, which perhaps is nothing new (Guattari 2000, Kalb 2013, Serres 2014).

In my artistic practice, one finds a certain affection for found materials, and for spaces of melancholic nature, left to their own fate. Here, one can read nature in two different aspects. Nature, the natural habitat of living organisms we humans fetishise for its wonder, and as well nature, as in the innate features of a being, an object, a space or even a force. It is important to distinguish the two meanings of this word, which humans have become so accustomed to. When in fact, these two notions can truly never be separated from each other, neither on an individual level nor as a collective (Gatz 2025, Ingold 2011).

The act of materialising one's existence has been central to my previous studies, and in my career as a fashion designer. Growing up in Stockholm, then moving to Berlin, exploring painting and music, eventually led to fashion design studies in Berlin and Antwerp. Internships then paved the way for a menswear designer position for a major luxury maison in Paris. The more experience I gained, the more my work seemed dependent on consumption, which I suppose is inevitable, and could very well have been foreseen long before. My master project at Konstfack is therefore heavily influenced by these experiences, constantly questioning for whom and for what reason we create structures of beauty, comfort and protection. Thus, leading me to a fear that the more one creates, the further we position ourselves from the actual feeling one searched to communicate.

To deter such a separation the question follows:

How can a closer emotional bond to materialism hold us safe while the world is trembling?

or rather more precisely,

In an ever-expanding material world created by humans, is there room for speculative textile making as a tool to reach a greater understanding of our relationship to what is not human?

This paper is a roadmap, which puts concepts of different thinkers in dialogue with my own trajectory, with the support of physical artworks and artefacts, as well as spaces and materials; a personal story as much as a master thesis. Therefore, I will use first person present when referring to my own work and findings, and to create a feeling of immediate immersion into the topic. The structure of this work mirrors my own process: fragmented and non-linear, moving through landscapes multidimensionally, without taking notice of space (as a physical constant) nor time (as is in our humanistic abstracted way of seeing time).

The first chapter of this paper will look at how we define nature today, which is important to better understand socio-ecological relationships, with the aim to decentralise the human role in the act of making art. Chapter two will explore how image development by materialisation, a process of gathering and re-crafting visual content, generates not only an image but a physical realm to interact with. Thirdly, a personal and imaginative theory of black strings is presented, as a metaphor for how everything around us is sensitively held together. The fourth chapter will examine how the human body is our sole means of experiencing everything we encounter. The paper will conclude with my own work as a proposition to implement findings in previous chapters for an immersive experience, reflecting on the fabric of materiality. Here, the idea of a garden becomes central as a concept for the installation. Yet, in this speculative landscape, am I the gardener or the intruder; a beast of unknown origin?



Image 3. Tree branches by the shores of *Hållsviken* bay in Södermanland, Sweden. Photo by the author.

Searching the wastes of imaginary landscapes

Chapter 1

August 18th

"Must it ever be thus, that the source of our happiness must also be the fountain of our misery? The full and ardent sentiment which animated my heart with the love of nature, overwhelming me with a torrent of delight, and which brought all paradise before me, has now become an insupportable torment, a demon which perpetually pursues and harasses me."

– Johann Wolfgang von Goethe, *The Sorrows of Young Werther* (1774)

While searching the digital archive of the Louvre museum, I came across a Renaissance tapestry titled *Deux bêtes sauvages fantastiques dans un décor de verdure à feuilles de chou* (Two wild fantastic beasts in a decor of cabbage-leaf greenery) (image 4). This work immediately struck my attention for several reasons. Firstly, the lack of humans in the motif, and then, discovering the present movement, a tension, yet with a calmness. As gazing upon a wild scenery, while at the same time being in an orderly garden with kind animals. This rather large tapestry (250x329cm), from the late 16th century, became an entry point to better understand my own practice. It seemed to inherit those properties of contradictory feelings, and ambivalence towards how to portray nature. Thus, I had to study this work *in situ*, and its image is now a central part of my own master project. Arriving in Lens on a grey February morning, I did not know exactly what to expect. As I was sitting on the concrete floor, in a huge restoration hall of *Centre de la Conservation du Louvre*, time and space seemed to stretch the fabric of materiality. In the motif, I recognised plants my grandparents had showed me in the Swedish forests, some edible, some pretty flowers. The title, given by the museum, makes me wonder, who is really the beast today?

To start with, I had to search for what the human idea of nature is today, as this tapestry perfectly mimics how we humans idealise nature's presence. After the opening sentence of chapter *August 18th* in *The Sorrows of Young Werther*, Goethe portrays a scene that still resonates today with a glorified idea of nature: "…yonder mountains across the river, and upon the green, flowery valley before me, and saw all nature budding and bursting around; the hills clothed from foot to peak with tall, thick forest trees..." (Goethe 1902, p.52). A type of environment that within visual arts has come to be described as a landscape (Clark 1976). The word landscape, however, is a human construct within art history that distances us from the environment itself. The amount of portrayed environments we are fed with today seems to have no end. As environment has become one of the most commonly used terms to talk about nature, it also seems to distance us from it. Rather than living within the environment, we are watching it, discussing it and fearing it, or rather fearing what we are doing to it (Ingold 2011, p.95). This reasoning seems to be in line with how Goethe writes, and further more, this contradiction is also reflected in the two different meanings of the word nature.

This separation could not be more misleading though, as society is interlinked with the environment in agencies very difficult to decipher. It seems it is our inability to cultivate such relationships on an individual level that has led to an ignorance of cause and effect. By categorising these relationships into different domains, one can more easily navigate the fields of interaction between the forces in question. One surely is the environment itself, which we are undoubtedly physically disconnected from. Then, there is the human subjectivity, constantly letting us shape our own experience of the environment. Thirdly, the social relations, our human cultures, that continuously shape our existence on an individual and collective level (Guattari 2000). These three domains act together to shape the way we, humans, interact with both each other and the physical world. Thus, culture itself truly never can be separated from nature. What culture is it then that has pushed for this separation, making us solely individuals disconnected from nature's wonder?

Looking at the techno-scientific development in the post-modern era of the West, capitalist enterprises have used their inventions, together with mass media, in the pursuit of infantilising the population for their own profit. Often so, with little (or no) concern of their environmental impact. By distancing the individual from the environment, the instant gratification of the novelty made for the masses replaces the pleasure in singular moments of each person (Guattari 2000, p.41-50). This is a rather stark argument, with a source originally published three decades ago. Mass media at the time would include radio, television and printed papers, which is rarely used today in the same sense. What a horror then, today each individual with direct access through smartphones and other devices providing non-stop news, globalised consumption and endless scrolling. Then again, we are at a tipping point in technology, where artificial intelligence could be the ultimate step of separation, as it removes the need of social interactions and the environment (Solnit 2026). Instinctively, I feel a need to fight this forced, yet disguised, separation. Otherwise, will it not become exactly as in the quote of Goethe, where nature is our own torment, all beauty around us demolished, only to produce another unknown entity's idea of the physical environment? A scenario where we are seemingly not the owners of our own imagination.



Image 4. *Deux bêtes sauvages fantastiques dans un décor de verdure à feuilles de chou*. c. 1585-1600. Collection of Musée du Louvre, Centre de la Conservation du Louvre, Lens, France. Reproduced with permission. Photo by the author.

To achieve a rejection of this development, one must work to decentralise the human role as an actor in the environment itself. One needs to look at nature with new eyes, giving each actor of one's habitat the possibility to impact the materialising. Architect Sebastian Gatz identifies three types of nature. Firstly, the actors with a will, that is mostly plants and animals. Secondly, there is everything that is matter: stones, a stick, etc. Thirdly, which is more difficult to grasp, the environment itself, the cosmos around us, which we normally interpret as physical laws (Gatz 2024, p.58). By identifying these actors, he can invite them to participate in the making of a speculative building in the little populated county of *Småland*, Sweden, for his doctoral thesis. Rather than overcoming the will of these actors, he seeks to create with them, giving them as much possibility to impact the final outcome as himself (Gatz 2024). This will perhaps not lead to what one normally would call the most successful building, but creates knowledge and meaning in terms of co-existence. This type of materialising gives way for a process requiring an everlasting imagination; what are the needs and pleasures of that bumblebee defying gravity, pulling nectar from the geranium on the windowsill of my Paris apartment, or in my grandmother's garden present deep in my memories? It becomes a way to cherish, each singular moment with the different actors present in the moment, but also in the past and the future. Only by letting each non-human individual, from the very smallest ones up to the immense forces of the universe, being your co-creator, one also becomes part of the environment itself. Imagination does not seem to belong to us alone, but exist only in relation to the non-human.

During the 15th and 16th centuries in Europe, no matter the quality of a tapestry, it remained exclusively available to the ruling classes, and especially the royal courts amassed grand collections. In fact, the whole tapestry market at the time was entangled with society, power and capitalism in an intricate pattern. Tapestry's insulating properties and portability, as they could easily be rolled up and hung in a new setting, fitted the current needs. Often made in series, they were not seen as singular artworks, but rather "textile environments" (Delmarcel 1999, p.16-18). For special occasions, tapestries were even hanged outside courts in short periods (Campbell and Wynn Ainsworth 2002, p.23). A substantial part of these collections where often *verdures* tapestries, mostly depicting greenery and animals. Workshops in Brussels, in the southern Netherlands, where at the time masters of such (Delmarcel 1999, p.139). These were less complicated to make than narrative scenes with intricate figures, thus also cheaper to produce (Campbell and Wynn Ainsworth 2002, p.24). Perhaps this explains why there are no humans present in the tapestry *Deux bêtes sauvages fantastiques dans un décor de verdure à feuilles de chou*, produced in Flanders c. 1585-1600.

This tapestry, which has had a considerable influence on my own practice, has, as far as is know, only been exhibited once in a museum, in 1966, and I am the only person to have requested to study it in over twenty years (Ribou, 2025, personal communication). Here, the beasts themselves are portrayed as guardians of dreamy groves, which are hiding under giant frightening leaves with sharp edges. Most likely, the maker had never seen a lion, as the beast to the right has hooves and a bushy tail (image 4). To the left, the beast resembles a bear, but with some more catlike features. In-between them, a swirl of leaves is hovering above a miniature cascade. The mix of perspective sucks one in, making it difficult to understand what is far away or close-by, creating a winding micro-macro landscape. There are plenty of actors to be found in the scenery, each one in their own way participating in the scene. Flowers, which many I recognise: field rose, true forget-me-not, marguerite, wood anemone, clematis, grape vines, blue bells and many more. Species I learnt from my grandmother, and my mother, growing up in Sweden. The more one studies the motif, the more diversity is to be discovered. Each plant seems to be an individual, with their own strong will, defying the heaviness of the dark cabbage leaves. At the top one can spot three bursting buds, half hidden in the greenery, which in fact shows that it is not something so gentle as cabbage leaves, but a sea of thistles. The birds though, seems perfectly comfortable, interacting with each other, picking at flowers, taking their flight above the thorns, or simply resting on a leaf. Just as, at the bottom, a lizard sits still on the soft moss (image 5), ready to take a leap at any moment. I wonder who dreamed up this imaginative landscape. Are these details influenced by the market at the time, or coming out of a spontaneous process of making? Whose memories and speculations are embedded in this yonder fragment?

A few conclusions can be made at this point. This textile came to my attention only through the digitalisation of an archive, which otherwise probably would have been outside of my reach. Through social relations, it was made possible for me to study this tapestry physically, which made a deep subjective imprint on my person. The natural motif presented, traverses time and space through my own experience, yet I am unsure as to what story is being told. The thistles spreading, could be seen as a protective shield for the environment, keeping us out of reach from the bustling beauty underneath. It could however, also be a romantic garden, where the invasive leafs are displacing the pleasure of the human will. Or perhaps, it is not to be analysed, but seen as a speculative space for wonder. Allowing one to interact with an imaginary landscape, a place that perhaps only exist within oneself, as vague as a feeling. Here, it is rather what is not seen generating forces, even though it is the recognition of each non-human actor, and the fantasy about their will, that elevates the human subjective experience. A crucial realisation, in my quest to strengthen the bond to my personal material world, found and constructed alike.



Image 5. Close-up of *Deux bêtes sauvages fantastiques dans un décor de verdure à feuilles de chou*. c. 1585-1600. Collection of Musée du Louvre, Centre de la Conservation du Louvre, Lens, France. Reproduced with permission. Photo by the author.

Wastes

"I.1.a. c. 1200 – Uninhabited (or sparsely inhabited) and uncultivated country; a wild and desolate region, a desert, wilderness. Somewhat rhetorical."

- Oxford English Dictionary (2024)

As I have mostly lived in urban areas all my life, I often fantasise about the vastness of nature. For the past seven years, Paris has been my home, a city with a long and intricate history, fuelling one's creativity and imagination. My own apartment, on *Rue des Poissonniers*, lays within the second most densely populated square kilometre of Europe (Rae 2018). The bustling life of the *18ème Arrondissement* has an unstoppable rhythm, and a constant lack of space. It is an environment where it is difficult to ever get a feeling of vastness, the sort of endless breath that only nature can provide.

Waste is a term that is rarely used today for its original meaning: a wild and untouched area (Oxford English Dictionary 2024). Such places have long been disregarded by modern human society, as they do not offer any sort of economic or social profit. A city is the very contradiction to such a terrain (Beau, Di Pietro & Robert 2022). Paris is, however, full of waste (Romana 2023). There is not only material waste, but also in-between spaces that seems to be left to waste. Those places, seemingly forgotten in space and time, exerts an uncertain pull, laying a path for fantasies. Though seemingly distant, nature can be found in such environments too. Writing about Paris in the 1970s, Henri Lefebvre divides the city into three categories, "the Paris of Knowledge", "the Political Paris" and "the Paris of Business, Commerce and Production" (Lefebvre 2003, p.153). Much may have changed since then, but it still illustrates an example of what such a capital symbolises. Everything opposing the structure of these three, including diverse groups such as homeless people to hippies, operates in what he calls the underground Paris (Lefebvre 2003, pp.157-158). Here is perhaps an ethical complication, as the rejection is not voluntarily in every case. However, this can be used as a model to identify alternative use of space, as a rejection to the separation between the individual and the environment, both in urban and natural settings.
It is within such environments, the materialisation of my work begins. By documentation, imagination and found materials, I reconstruct my own subjective idea of places in my proximity, often places dear to me or representative of my inner self. The documentation is done by photography (image 6 and 7) and recording sounds. The imaginative part is done by writing and sketching (image 12). During these explorative field trips, which I undertake continuously, both planned and spontaneous (or rather consciously and unconsciously), I also gather materials, which I then use to construct new structures and surfaces. It is a search for matter that sits trembling, waiting to tell its story; containers able to speak the truth of their origin while also resonating with my own artistic desire. The journey is an unknown and intricate path, where I link places otherwise disconnected from each other. Together, these three methods for gathering notions of space, acts to form what I call image development by materialisation. A non-linear process, where the fragments I have gathered becomes enlarged and assembled through different techniques, to create new immersive spaces built for sensation. Two sites are the main source of translation for this project, the *18ème Arrondissement* of Paris and the *Hållsviken* bay in *Södermanland*. Two spaces, separated geographically and in time, one being my current urban home. The other, the rural family home where I spent childhood holidays at my grandparents, and today, with my parents. Two spaces, deeply rooted within me. The more I investigate these spaces, the more similarities I discover. In both cases, I find myself to be an intruder. Rather than the beast protecting the beauty, I am entering unknown lands that slips between my fingers.



Image 6. Small in-between wasteland by *Rue Ordener* in Paris, France. 2023. Photo by the author.



Image 7. Train tracks leading to *Gare du Nord*, traversing the *18ème Arrondissement* of Paris, France. 2023. Photo by the author.



Image 8. *Last testament of forest thoughts* - installed in a backyard of *Rue des Poissonniers,* Paris, France. (Gösta von Platen, 2025).

In February 2025, I set out to explore how a temporary space could affect its immediate surroundings while gathering material and knowledge for new works tied to these specific places. *Last Testament of Forest Thoughts* (image 8), is a large scale photograph of the forest by *Hållsviken*, screen-printed on a tarp found nearby. This cloth made of plastic strips, had over time lost its shielding properties. Instead, it gained smells and hues from the very elements it was meant to protect from. Unknowingly, my photograph became the forest's final image before it was clear-cut. With charcoal powder made from sticks left at the clear-cut (image 9), I printed the image onto the tarp. With leftover wood from my parent's cabin, I built a portable structure to carry it. Thus, creating a physical memory made from the forest itself. It then became evident, the forest had to come with me to Paris. There, I sought in-between spaces that echoed the forest's clear-cut absence: micro-wastelands embedded within dense urban systems (image 10). Though geographically distant, these spaces shared a language of melancholy and chaos. Searching for different actors of nature was difficult, with little life beyond human activity. Materials I hoped to find for new works, were nowhere to be found, instead most things disgusted me. My portable installation did not put forward the will of the forest itself, nor the inhabitants or elements that once composed it, but rather stood as a testament to an environment constructed, as this forest initially was planted, and later destroyed by humans. This experience was pivotal to my master project, seeing how image, material and action worked together to shape a new sensation, initiated by my own desire but not with the will of the forest at centre.

Further down south, in Marseille, there is an underground nightclub called *Metaphore Collectif*. A self-proclaimed "*Espace libre*", which in this context can be translated to "Space of freedom". To enter *Metaphore Collectif*, to even gain knowledge of their location, one has to first become a member of their cultural association. In-between a desolate construction sight, bushes and train tracks, a small unmarked path leads to the entrance. Before entering, they conduct a body search, control your membership, and give you a briefing of the rules: no discrimination, no harassment, no so-called overconsumption (of alcohol or drugs) and explain the structure of the venue. Outside, an old caravan functions as a ticket booth. The building itself, an old garage, one enters through a small door in a huge blue metal port. This location exist undercover since many years, and before entering, I reflect on how silent the night is. But inside another reality is taking place, with people talking, drinking, laughing and dancing. A space re-crafted for sensations, through communication and movement (Metaphore Collectif 2025). Studying this type of environment makes me realise how underground nightclubs, often located in urban wastelands, are perhaps some of the most successful environments to experience purely with the senses. It is a safe space for interaction, and for letting go of one's own self, yet with a certain tension and uncertainty present, such as strong lights, energetic music and unknown bodies. These are feelings I share in my exploration of both natural and urban environments, as well as in my own making. Just like the underground Paris of Lefebvre, and nature's own non-human actors in any city, *Metaphore Collectif* seems a floating island of desire in the midst of destructive capitalism. In a larger perspective, one could argue nature is becoming an underground space, such as the forest by *Hållsviken* being surrounded by capitalism. Perhaps here lays a key to the continuation of my endeavour, as it is not for nature I create, but a space where the audience can sense a rejection to the negligence of our environment. A space which is not built on knowledge, but on sensation. Again, it is the actors and forces hidden within these wastelands, which gives life to one's materialisation.



Image 9. Process of making charcoal from sticks found at the clear-cut by *Hållsviken*, Sweden. 2025. Photo by the author.



Image 10. *Last Testament of Forest Thoughts* - video documentation of field work in the *18ème Arondissement* of Paris, France. (Gösta von Platen, 2025). Photo by Marta Pellón Brussosa.



Image 11. *Last testament of forest thoughts* - installed on *Dalagatan* in Stockholm, Sweden.
(Gösta von Platen, 2025). Photo by Alice Zerini-Le Reste.



Image 12. *Dreams a'perched* - gathering notions of space through aquarelle painting. (Gösta von Platen, 2024).

Black string theory

Chapter 3

"When it comes to understanding the fabric of the universe, most of what scientists think exists is consigned to a dark, murky domain. Ordinary matter, the stuff we can see and touch, accounts for just 5% of the cosmos. The rest, cosmologists say, is dark energy and dark matter, mysterious substances that are labeled "dark" partly to reflect our ignorance about their true nature"

- Steve Nadis, *Quanta Magazine (2024)*

When living in cities abroad, memories of the Swedish nature, where I spent my childhood holidays, merge with my fantasies. Together, they often take shape as a dark space, where the walls are black, sharp as volcanic rock and filled with fog. Is this the world we will face in the Anthropocene era? There is no such thing in science as a black string theory, but in my work I have for long reflected on different themes of darkness. This is where my black string theory took shape, as a vision, of everything around me held together by black strings. This theory came to me during a personal period filled with anxiety, which originated during the Covid pandemic. A time filled with fears for the surrounding material world. Not so much for my own sake, but for the others around me, and for what unknown which was living inside of me. Objects around me seemed to be covered in black slime, or rather becoming covered as I touched them. Over time, and with help from a psychologist, I learned to control my fears and accept this condition; my own mental state and that of the world at that moment. Then, the black slime instead seemed to be pulled out, creating strings between structures, objects and people. These black strings were connecting everything around me, physically and mentally, as through different dimensions. I was at the time in my small apartment in Paris, it was lock-down, but as the city opened up and closed down again, over and over, memories and dreams seemed to be more and more mixed with reality.

Coming back to Stockholm, I found myself at a crossroad. On the one hand, an eagerness to create, to use the abundant workshops and the knowledge at hands of both teachers and fellow students at Konstfack. Finally, being part of a context within the domain of arts, if only as a student, felt like a major shift. On the other hand, it is now up to me to set my own rules for making, throwing me into an abyss of doubt concerning the use of materials. I came here, because I felt the consumerism side of the fashion industry seemed in conflict with my own concerns for planet Earth. Even though, feeling fulfilled by creating beautiful garments, and partaking in extraordinary projects, I had a growing feeling of not serving the world I would like to live in; leading to feelings of guilt and fear. Nonetheless, I had to had to keep up the rhythm of the workflow: new ideas, new designs and ever growing collections. I realised how the wide mix of compositions in materials, and the high production rate of objects, is masking the fact that all matter on Earth is constant; a continuous process of transformation. Circularity is often mentioned as crucial to sustainable developments in the fashion industry, but overseen as a philosophical concept which could help us better understand the emotional aspects of materials (Petreca et al. 2025). This is where my affection for found materials has its origin, as they seem to inherit a character of their own.

The universe is described by scientist to mostly consist of dark energy and dark matter, unseeable for the human eye (Kazmierczak 2025). Perhaps, this is also true for everyday objects: both advanced technological objects, such as smartphones, and something as simple as a t-shirt, has many components which to the user are unknown. The same goes for the found objects and materials I use in my practice, even though they seem to carry a certain history of their own. Still, in both cases, when trying to understand their origin, one quickly enters a murky domain. The more I drew up my plans for my master, the more I started to question what impact such a project would have on the environment. As I want to be true to my own ideas, and feelings, I had to start at the origin of the material. Being within the textile craft department enhanced this desire, which would perhaps not have been the case studying the broader field of fine art. It seemed to be a question of letting the work itself be true to its concept, its opinion and presented in a context honest to its story. This is a difficult thing to ask of the work itself, because it will quickly suffer from a lack of possibilities. The settings and materials usually at hands, such as a white gallery space, fabric, paint, wood for a frame, even metal screws, were in conflict with the very subject of the project.

When conducting my archival research at the Louvre, I also had the chance to study a textile fragment dating back about 1500 years (image 13). I was first drawn to it due to the sheer age of its existence, mesmerised by how a small cloth consisting of natural fibres and dyes survived long over a millennium. This is in fact an assemblage of fragments that has been composed by a French collector in modern times, before passed on to the collection of the Louvre (The Louvre Collections 2026). An intricate border frames two figures, one of them representing Bacchus holding a thyrsus (Lapeyrie-Manteau 2025, personal communication). Again, sparking my interest, as he was the Greek god of both ecstasy and fertility, a deity responsible for nature and human frenzy (March 2014, p.162). I will not go into detail about mythology here, nor the provenance of this object, but this tabula informed me on my own theory. Looking closely, with a loupe, the fibres of the yarn flow in different directions, mixing with the varying stitches of embroidery and assembly (image 14). Zooming in, it is as entering another dimension, where the material speaks the story of the motif. The fibres becomes an intricate network of strings, encapsulating the actors of the motif, the material, and myself as a viewer. The bordure, with animals and plants in its ornament, acts as both a portal and a cage (image 13). Again, the fabric of materiality seems stretched beyond time and space, as entering another dimension, where darkness infiltrates my memories of people and places. The strings visible here, create a protective shell to that other dimension, while also isolating one from the physical environment. Back in Stockholm, I materialised this vision with felted wool and charcoal pigment, as a small portal to that other dimension (image 15).



Image 13. *Tabula; fragment.* Byzantine period c. 395-641. Collection of Musée du Louvre, Paris, France. Reproduced with permission. Photo by the author.



Image 14. *Tabula; fragment, close-up.* Byzantine period ca. 395-641. Collection of Musée du Louvre, Paris, France. Reproduced with permission. Photo by the author.



Image 15. *Black string theory* - screen-print with charcoal pigment on felted wool. (Gösta von Platen 2025).

Vessel of bodily cloth

Chapter 4

"We, though, while we're intent upon one thing,
can feel the cost and conquest of another.
Hostility's our first response. Aren't lovers
for ever reaching verges in each other, —
lovers, that looked for spaces, hunting, home?
Then, for the sudden sketchwork of a moment,
a ground of contrast's painfully prepared,
to make us see it. For they're very clear
with us, we that don't know our feeling's shape,
but only that which forms it from outside."

- Rainer Maria Rilke, *Duino Elegies* (1923)

It felt natural to turn to tapestries, to explore how humans have experienced the environment over time, since their very essence is cloth, formed through the interweaving of differently coloured threads. A vivid metaphor for our deep interconnection with our surroundings. At this point of time, the body is the only tool for humans to experience the world with, as it is what gives us the possibility to use our senses. This is perhaps, one of the must important realisations when trying to understand how we situate ourselves in the landscapes that we are living within. Our body is not a mere tool for registering, but rather the tool which activates one's being (Butler 2015, p.42). In *Musée de Cluny* in Paris, the tapestry series *The Lady and the Unicorn* is made up of six tapestries, each one representing one of our senses, and then, a sixth mysterious one (image 16). In each motif, the lady is interacting with objects portraying each sense being used; touch, smell, vision, taste and hearing. To help her, there is a unicorn and a lion, as well as other animals, and in two of them, there is also a woman. In each scene, they are situated on an island floating in a decor of a thousand flowers, a technique called *mille fleure*, as if existing in a vast magical landscape. These tapestries exemplify how we experience with our body, while also distancing ourselves from the very materially of the world we are seeking to experience. They also stand in stark contrast to the nature that the tapestry *Deux bêtes sauvages fantastiques dans un décor de verdure à feuilles de chou* portrays (image 4). When one touches something, that entity which is being touched is reflected in our bodily situation. Touch can not occur unless there is something to be touched, but the subject is unknowing of one's presence prior to that occurrence. It must then have held a certain energy before the touch happened. The feeling is then not only something experienced, created by one's body, but rather given to one and activated by the body (Butler 2015, p.47). This example could be applied to any of our known five senses. Does this mean it is the outside of oneself that is animating the inner self, our consciousness? If so, this reflection calls for the impossibility of separating the inside from the outside.

The different use of containers made of cloth, for our bodies and belongings, has been vital to the evolution of human kind. Studying these, can give a more profound understanding of how humans have experienced Earth over time (Otter 2024.) Seeing cloth, as a vessel for the body, gives way to fantasies of how we traverse the world of our everyday life. As Rilke writes, we do not know the shape of the feeling itself, but only of that which formed it (Rilke 1963, p.41). A filled container however, whatever its shape, position or path it may take, will eventually and inevitably leak from its openings (Pyyhtinen and Zavos 2024, p.88). The original shape of cloth is flat, a surface, that only through different modes of construction takes a portable form, becoming a garment (Dormor 2020). Cloth, in the form of a garment, is both what protects and separates one from the outside (Gilligan 2023, p.646). Thus, it can be seen as a vessel, which holds the body through life while searching for one's own floating island; a home. A certain trust must then be asked of the garment, its material and construction, and in an extent, the environment it is situated within. Shaping an uncertainty: is it the subject, here the body being held, leaking out of the surface, or the milieu intruding one's body? Together, the sources presented in this chapter call for a trinity of textile, body and environment, which can never be separated. If, as Rilke implies, hostility is our first response to the elements we face, it is due to the fear our sensations are asserting. Then, cloth is certainly a sort of vessel, with the main aim to hold one safe as the world is trembling. If now feeling is the main concern of the body, so must also be of the cloth, as it is our constructed verge to the outside.

In the book of *Physiologus*, beasts appear as heroic and magical, with power out of reach for humans (Curley 2009). The book first appeared around 140-400 A.D, drawing upon myths of Egyptian, Hebrew and Indian culture, later mixed with Greek and Roman; but is ultimately a work of Christian belief, widely rendered during the Middle Ages in Europe (Curley 2009, pp.9-18). Yet, the virtues accustomed to each animal, tree and stone one finds in this book are a mirroring of the Christian human worldview at the time. Instead of revealing any truth about nature, it uses these actors to dictate what humans should care for spiritually and morally (Badke 2004). This seems to be the purpose of the animals in *The Lady and the Unicorn* as well, whose sixth tapestry is titled *À mon seul désir* (To my sole desire), inscribed on the tent in the scene. Instead of sensory depiction, it gestures toward human's conscious power over our senses (Delmarcel 1999, p.52). This ambiguous act, placing or removing her jewels, I believe can also be seen as a turning inward. This inwardness seems not sealed off from the world, rather, it is formed through her prior entanglement with it. After the body has touched, smelled, seen, tasted and heard, desire becomes something to be controlled. To an extent, *À mon seul désir,* does not prove power over the senses, but gathers them, as an act of bodily consciousness that recognises its own permeability. Like cloth, desire here becomes a vessel: neither purely internal nor external, but a threshold where the world has already left its trace. The sixth tapestry thus completes the series by acknowledging that what we call inner life is always woven from outside forces. Showing how our most intimate gestures are shaped by the landscapes we have moved through. It seems, beasts, as many can be seen in these tapestries, are not always of malicious intent, but rather a figure holding a certain spiritual power. Leading one back again to the question of the previous chapters: what notions are forming the self? If it is the landscapes, both urban and natural, now disappearing due to our own human actions, then even with the best intensions, we become not beasts of virtue, but of fear, as we move through the darkness of post-modern Western civilisation.



Image 16. *The Lady and the Unicorn*. c. 1500. Musée de Cluny, Paris, France.
Public domain. Photo by the author.



Image 17. Lions. Copperplate engraving by van der Borcht, from a Dutch edition of Physiologus, 1588. Reproduced under collection terms. Available at: https://spcoll.library.uvic.ca/Digit/physiologum/animal/lion2.htm



Image 18. Pocket bag remnants from a pair of trousers, found in the *18ème arrondissement* of Paris, France. 2025. Photo by the author.

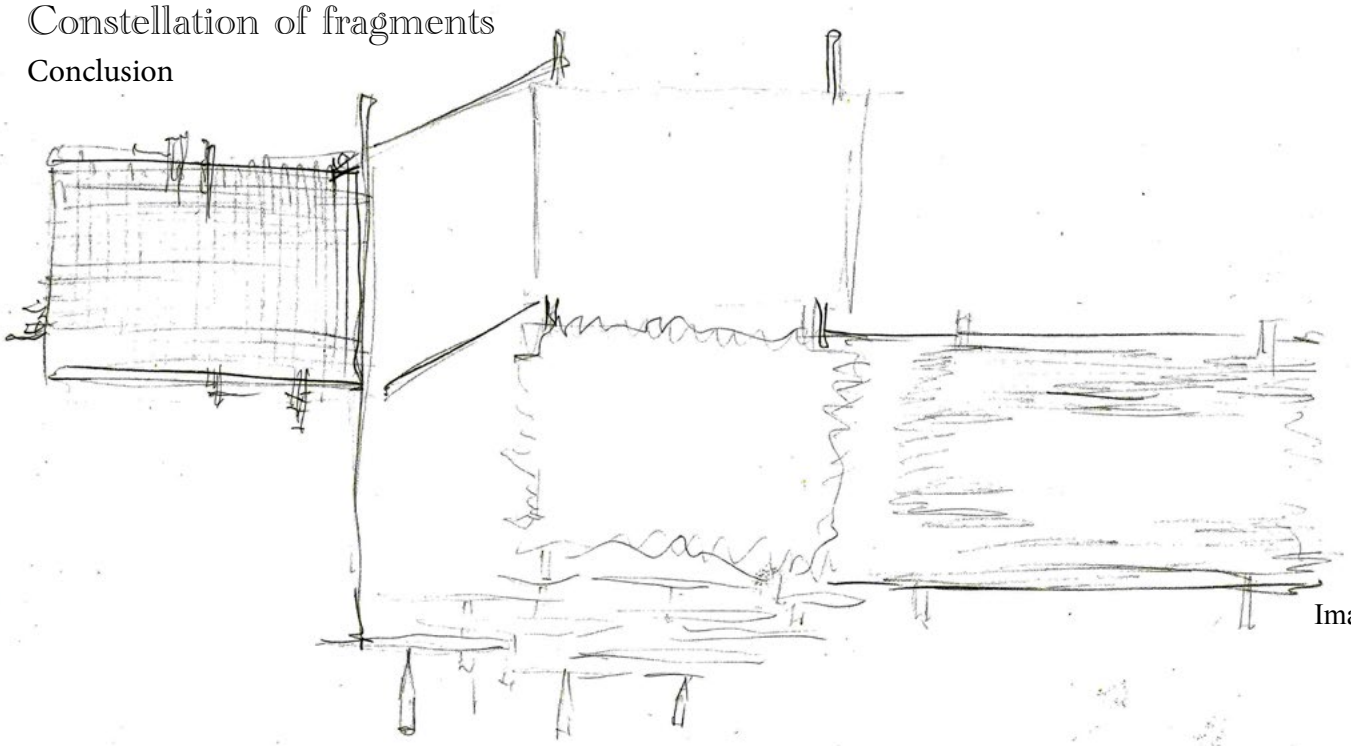


Image 19. Sketch for installation. (Gösta von Platen, 2025).

Now, as an artist, I move through the spaces introduced in the previous chapters, seeking to exit my body to objectively see what outcome this paper might give. Yet, drawing from the last chapter, must not the conclusion be, that no matter how thoughtfully we try to detach the self from subjectivity, it is the very matter itself that shapes our ambition. Then, how could I even try to judge the results objectively? Instead, the conclusion must be built on the sensation of the work itself. One could even argue, that the sensation of an artwork should be the sole interest in making, even when the desire of the artist is to change the trajectory of a certain topic. In my case, the sole solution then, is to approach my materials as active participants in the making. Although, as an artist, I have too much of a desire for control to let them roam free. It is still me, who is both the initiator and the owner of their will. However, by using unconventional materials for creating textiles, or unconventional textiles as support for images, I let the material itself take on a bigger role in the story being told, without imposing history upon it.

Even though seemingly gathered in a random manner, it is my care for these materials that turn them into a valuable body of work. Just as in fashion, when creating a collection of clothes, here these fragments makes up a constellation. It is perhaps most closely to be seen as a garden, providing both comfort and nutrients for me, present viewers and future humans alike, in need of continuous care to stay alive. A garden is also a highly immersive space, just as I aim my work to be. This is where the tapestry *Deux bêtes sauvages fantastiques dans un décor de verdure à feuilles de chou* has played a significant role, as it informed how to landscape my garden, even inspiring the soundscape composed for this project.

Yet, a garden is also not in complete control of the gardener. Just as my own work, especially when introduced to new environments, I am not able to foresee threats and reactions. It remains a speculative landscape, built on my own human projection of what nature is. A further step would be to invert this process, creating singular moments for nature itself. This is where I believe we need to change our focus on what we see as nature, letting it take up more underground space. The urban already seems to be its new natural habitat, as the non-human is everywhere, constantly shaping our existence. By giving those actors more space we also gain knowledge for our own individual pleasure. Which leads back to another realisation: is that then not the same as imposing one's own desire on nature?

I see the artworks created for this project as fragments, which together form a spatial constellation. Detailed documentation of eight of the works is provided together with photographs in the appendix Fragmets. Each fragment represents an exploration, illustrated by using a technique, suitable to re-craft my subjective idea of the space in question, where image and material both support each other. As in the melancholy and chaos of the felted wool, where raw fibres from a Swedish sheep become a beasty looking landscape, with a vague image of train tracks leading to *Gare du Nord*. Or as the leaves of the common reed, offering a sheltering wall, but to fragile too even keep the slightest breeze unnoticed, where the abandoned lot on *rue Ordener* in the *18ème Arrondissement* emerges. The two beasts also gained new freedom through 3D-printing and sublimation, placed in a new landscape (image 20). This is what I call image development by materialisation. It is my own way of making tapestry by combining gathered materials with both new and ancient technologies. A method which can act as a tool to foster a closer relationship to the surrounding material world. These speculative textiles helped create a bond to the non-human actors of my immediate environment, while also connecting with my own senses through the bodily engagement with the materials in the process of making. My findings does not provide safety per se, but shows our inevitable entanglement with matter, which can foster a more emotional dialogue with my immediate material world. This paper can thus act as a roadmap, making otherwise hidden patterns visible.

When transported, they are rolled up, folded or gathered in a cloth, becoming vessels, not for me, but for the space they speak of. They hold the trembling notion of the bodily sensation that can be found in the intersection of the urban and the natural; fear and desire in constant exchange. This fluctuating state of the artworks invites looking back in time and forward; standing in the middle, one is at the centre of a material whirlwind. Thus, these works acts as portals, which can help connect spaces otherwise physically disconnected, yet simultaneously present within the body. I cannot promise this installation will hold you safe, as it is only a humble proposition for feeling the fabric of materiality more present (image 21). More field work now awaits, to see how these works reacts to different sites. If I, as an artist and human, am a guarding beast, a dyeing cub, or a tormenting demon, only time will tell.



Image 20. Three works in process for the final installation of *Trembling Matter.* (Gösta von Platen, 2026).



Image 21 (spread over page 30 and 31). The first test of assembling the fragments of *Trembling Matter* as a constellation. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).





Image 22. *Two fantastic beasts guarding a wild tree* - installed with portable wood structure. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).



Image 23. *Two fantastic beasts guarding a wild tree* - packed up together with portable wood structure. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).

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34. von Platen, Gösta. (2026). Installation view of *Trembling Matter* at the Konstfack degree exhibition [installation]. Photo by the author.

35. von Platen, Gösta. (2026). Listening area at the at the Konstfack degree exhibition [installation]. Photo by the author.

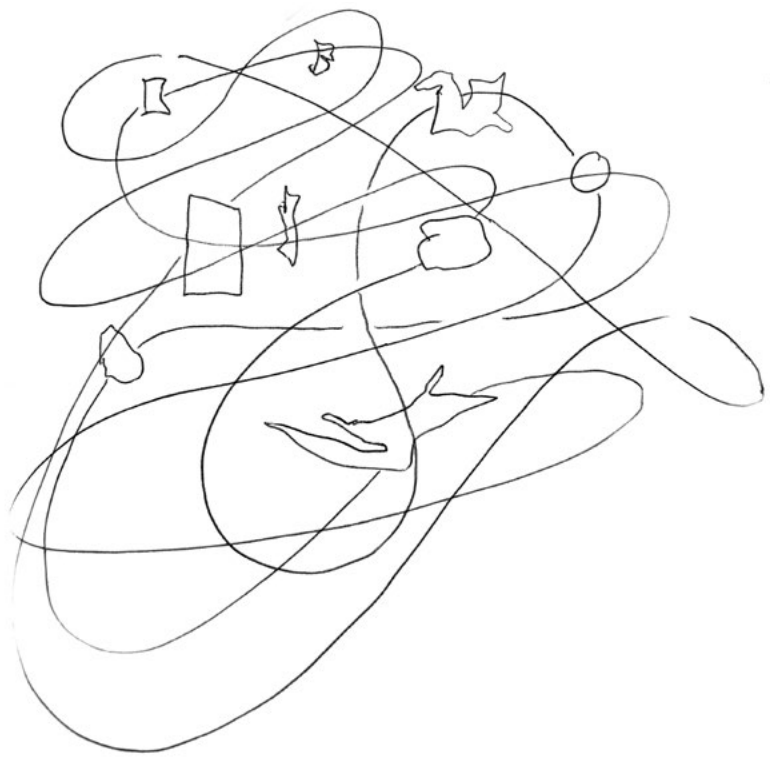


Image 24. *Material whirlwind* - sketchbook journal (Gösta von Platen, 2024).



Image 25. *The beast* - Felted wool, charcoal, rust and screen-print emulsion. (Gösta von Platen. 2026).

1. The Beast

Not far from my home, the train tracks cuts through the *18ème Arrondissement* of Paris. They form one of the entry points to the city for the trains arriving at *Gare du Nord*. Along these chaotic verges, different bridges span sharp openings carved into the urban landscape. Standing on one of them, I feel my body as only a small fibre of a tumultuous network of connections. This allegory, embedded in the shifting structures, people, movement and matter, awakened in me a desire to capture that present tension.

Felted wool is said to be among the earliest textiles used by humans, discovered by chance when humidity and friction entangled the fibres of raw wool; many legends tell stories of how wool in relation to the human body formed the material (Thompson 2011, p. 26). Felted wool is known for its protective properties, historically used not only for clothing but also shelter and various other purposes. It carries spiritual significance in many cultures, as well as in modern art (Thompson 2011). European wool, however, is today under-utilised and often treated as waste due to low textile market value and limited processing infrastructure (Camilli et al. 2025). Recently, a certain resurgence within contemporary design has sought to change this, such as The Swedish Wool Initiative (AxFoundation 2025).

When wool is felted, the microscopic scales on the fibres open and attaches to each other in a random manner (Fashionary 2019, p. 181). It felt like the perfect material which through visualise my moment on the bridge. To further materialise this image, I worked with charcoal I made myself in *Hållsviken*, and rust gathered from an old chain laying by the pier. Many times I have entered Paris along those train tracks, many times I have left the same way. This painting now acts as an embodiment of that juxtaposition; carrying with it the tension of transit.



Image 26. *Vassen* - Leaves of the common reed, sewing thread, found metal objects, varnish and repurposed wood. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).

2. Vassen

Do you see something? My mum is asking as we make our way through the dense thicket of common reed, filling all the shores along *Hållsviken*. It is winter, the mud is frozen, and the winding paths from animals takes us further and further in. Even though seemingly a fragile habitat of the ecosystem, their stems still stand tall and shining bright in the winter sun. By springtime the new shoots will reach up simultaneously as the previous ones disintegrates, creating an endless cycle. I was looking for a material that I could gather myself in my very proximity, here next to my family's country house, in the bay where my mum was born.

The use of reed can be traced back to Neolithic times, and was widely available all over Europe. It was used for for many purposes such as walls, fish-traps, pulp for paper, mats, and as we mostly commonly know perhaps, and still use today, thatching for roofs. By natural climate changes and the development of modern agriculture techniques throughout Europe in the 20th century the wetlands along the shores declined massively, and so also the reed (Wichmann and Köbbing 2015). Today, reed is still a very common plant along all the shores of the Baltic Sea. It has also spread over the oceans, in the US it is now considered an invasive species (von Arnold 2025). Here, in the calm waters around the small peninsula of *Tuna ö* in *Hållsviken* bay, there seem to be no lack of availability for my needs.

I proceeded with gathering leaves of the reed in August 2025, which I then dried to be able to store them until the winter months. Back at Konstfack, with two bags filled with curled up leafs, I start the process of ironing them flat, one by one. To make my canvas, I stitch them together, one by one, on an industrial sewing machine. What makes me shiver is the tension of taking something seemingly so fragile, yet with a unbelievable strength, and run it through a machine. The result is pleasing, as the textures and layers in combination with the thread makes for an almost hypnotic yet frozen movement.



Image 27. *Two fantastic beasts guarding a wild tree* - 3D-printed mesh in PLA with sublimation print. (Gösta von Platen. 2026).

3. Two fantastic beasts guarding a wild tree

After having studied the tapestry *Deux bêtes sauvages fantastiques dans un décor de verdure à feuille de chou* at the Louvre archive, the presence of the two beasts stayed with me. It requires four persons to take the tapestry out of the archive. Over the following months, I grew a longing to myself be able to interact with this imaginary landscape. Thus, I searched for a technique that could give life to them, shedding new light on my concerns discussed in this paper.

In the introduction course to the 3D-print studio of Konstfack, I found the NASA-chainmail design available online at tingiverse.com (ConnorMPrints 2017). Seeing how this was essentially an online found textile, made physical by printing it, opened new ideas to what a found material is today. The fact that I also discovered the image of the tapestry online, amplified the idea of recreating a historical textile with this method.

PLA is a plant-based biodegradable plastic made from lactic acid derived mostly from corn and sugarcanes (Lefteri 2014, p. 90). Its degradable properties can however be debate, as it only works in an industrial setting (nova-Institute et al. 2024). Thus, it was not without doubts that I embarked on this marathon making project. Even though the 3D-printer made most of the job, the total print-time was about 800 hours, not including the extensive testing to integrate the sublimation print. Each section of 20x20cm coming out of the printer then had to be assembled by hand, and even though it is plastic, it stays much more fragile than a tapestry made of natural fibers. In my composition, I let the beasts guard a tree, which in its appearance seem wild. There is a strong melancholy present, as I could imagine this to be the only way to re-craft nature in a dystopian future; on an Earth not able to provide for neither natural fibers nor untamed natural habitats.



Image 28. *Exertion speaks through you* - Oil on found coconut fibre rug, sticks, thread and dead-stock metal hooks. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).

4. Exertion speaks through you

At the beginning of this project, I made a sketch in my notebook: a dark figure taking or holding something out of a tree, the hollow inside of the tree shining. It was a spontaneous reflection at the time on my guilt and fear of using natural resources for my own art project. I then found two rugs in the old barn next to my parents cottage in *Hållsviken*. They were rolled up, filled with mouse droppings and dust. Once out, they were shimmering in the early spring sun, sharing the same color of the pine needles spread on the ground; as if these coarse textiles were merging with the surface underneath. The shadow of my own body fell over one of the rugs, as a giant towering above its new habitat.

My sketch echoed in my head when seeing my own shadow. Nearby, I found some sticks, or rather limbs of branches, that seemed to have been cut straight of a living tree; as nature's own relics in the Anthropocene. I placed these sticks on the rug, then marking the positions in a way that the sticks also could be inserted, cut up the fibers with strong pliers and finally finished them with a tight buttonhole stitch by hand. After that, I primed the surface with gesso to be able to use it as my canvas for water soluble oil paint.

This discarded coconut fiber rug thus gained new life as a sculptural painting. The different parts interact and depend on each other, as it is the sticks that stretches the canvas. Three metal hooks attaches directly into the structure of the weave, which can be hanged from many types of supports. Being able to roll it up and easily carry it, connects it to the concept of 16th century tapestry. The figure, crouching in a sweeping landscape, is seemingly exposed to the powers of nature. But, the gesture of holding an amorphous object, could also be a gesture towards self-reflection on human's negative influence.



Image 29. *Implosion is imminent* - Oil on found coconut fibre rug, piece of pine tree trunk, metal pipe, ceramic fragment, bolts and eyelets . (Gösta von Platen, 2026).

5. Implosion is imminent

On an early morning walk this winter, I followed a small path starting right behind the house. The grey fog of dawn still lay as a filter over the forest floor. The heavy fir tree branches threw long shadows, adding an uneasy presence to shapes and textures. Behind the dark canopy the first sunbeams played with the colors of the sky and the clouds. The path follows the northern side of a cliff, and on the other side the ground runs dawn into a small swamp. This short part of the path always held a certain mystery, being slightly colder and more damp, as if something was hiding in this in-between.

But my walk was interrupted as a huge murky branch was blocking the way. It must have fallen in the violent autumn storms of 2025. My eyes followed the thick wooden body down the slope, it was intriguing, as if pointing me towards the source of a well hidden secret. With some hesitation, as if some animal or creature was watching my steps, I pushed the curtain of firs to the side.

The fallen log was perhaps seven meters long. At the base, three more branches laid on the ground, each one perfectly fallen straight out from the center, as if the trunk had been split in four. I stood in the center, looking up, imagining what had happened here. Was it the lighting? Was it the wind? In any case, it was not human. Some other force had been at work here. After completing the painting, the two found objects merged with the image, while also acting as a supporting structure to hang it. The wooden stump is clearly cut with a chainsaw, while the metal pipe is more difficult to interpret. Still, both these objects somehow holds that same rather uneasy and violent feeling experienced when standing at the place of where that tree once lived.



Image 30. *Shadow seeking refuge* - Screen-print on fabric, rust pigment, repurposed wood, black string, found metal and wood elements. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).

6. Shadow seeking refuge

Heading out on *Tuna ö*, a narrow cliff ridge cuts through the forest and stretches toward the tip of the peninsula. I have always enjoyed exploring this small piece of rather untouched land. The small ridge has many crevices where the trees take on whimsical shapes. The rock face is mostly covered with white moss, giving it a magical glow at the end of the day. When there is almost no light left, and the sky is turning dark blue, the ground lights up. The photograph of this tree was taken in that fleeting moment.

I have for long been fascinated by windows, as portals to the outside. A curtain introduces a dual possibility: it can conceal both the exterior and the viewer from what lies beyond. The fabric used for this curtain comes from my time as a fashion designer, it is partially see-through, which mirrors the properties of a window. The photograph is printed in a tone that recalls the white moss of *Tuna ö*. The frame is hand-painted, incorporating rust pigment derived from a chain found near the pier on the island.

The work exist as an ambiguous object, adaptable to many spatial settings. Against a window, it becomes a window in a window, luring the viewer to an outside that is not there. Hung against a wall, it gives the illusion of an absent opening. Suspended freely in a room, the fabric becomes a structure, creating an imagined interior; a shelter hidden in the nook of the small pine tree.



Image 31. *Act of Balance* - Agave leaves and turned wood. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).

7. Act of Balance

When conducting field studies in Marseille in February 2025, my friend Dimitri Felouzis led a walk up to the basilica *Notre dame de la Garde*. From there, a winding path goes through *Jardin du Bois Sacré* (The Garden of Holy Wood), down to the shores. It was there that I found these dead and dry agave leaves, laying in a big pile, as if the plant itself had imploded.

In the Calanques National Park bordering Marseille, agave is considered an invasive exotic species that spreads from cultivated areas into natural landscapes, where it competes with native vegetation (Calanques-parcnational.fr, 2017). What I found resemble something prehistoric, leather like in its textures and stiff as a fossil. I explored many ways of how to use them as a material: softening them with steam, making holes with an awl, sewing them by hand. My aim was to elevate its own presence, but none of these methods had such an effect. Despite their hostile appearance, these leaves are fragile entities; found by me in a supposedly, as the name of the garden suggests, spiritual place on a rocky mountain.

I carried these leaves with me back to Stockholm on the train. Wrapped in a black plastic bag, stuck with some string directly to my suitcase. The whole affair felt rather brutal, and I needed the presentation to mirror this paradox. I therefor gave each leaf its own mountain to balance on, in form of a spike in turned wood. A black cloth with custom fitted attachments became a bag in which they are wrapped together; as an installation which can quickly be assembled outside, as long as the surface is stable enough to support their standing.



Image 32. *Chaotic cloth* - Found textiles, linen thread, wooden stick, gesso and oil paint. (Gösta von Platen, 2026).

8. Chaotic cloth

Each one of the textiles, composing the canvas for this painting, can be traced back to an earlier era of rural Sweden. My maternal grandparents had a general store at the end of *Hållsviken* bay up until 1968. The two garments used, a shirt and a ribbed jumper, both comes from the old stock of that shop. When they moved, and with them the business, to the nearest village of *Västerljung*, the previous store turned into a summerhouse for the family. The pillowcase comes from that era, and has made its way into the household textiles of my parents. The sac I found in an abandoned barn, previously used for grain storage, in Rejmyre, Sweden, during a residency exploring site specific post-rural artistic work.

By assembling these textiles by hand, I found myself to be reliving a history otherwise difficult to imagine. It was as if I was looking through the eyes of the people that once interacted with these cloths. Back to an era of rural Sweden, which my grandparents where a part of. I wonder what their relation to the surrounding nature was at the time? They grew up on two neighboring farms, where they for sure did not have the same modern comfort as me growing up in Stockholm.

Since 2004, my parents have their own cottage a little bit further out the *Hållsviken* bay. I normally sleep in a tiny guest house facing the woods. In there, the walls of raw wood seems an extension of the surrounding forest. Tall pine trees encircle the house, with long branches stretching down to the ground. By using these textiles as my canvas, I do not only paint the room, but aim to materialise the physicality of my bodily feeling of that space. Just as any piece of cloth, the painting can be folded and stored away when not worn, or the painting itself can be worn as a garment, extending its portability even further.



Image 33. Installation view of *Trembling Matter* at the Konstfack CRAFT! exam exhibition (Gösta von Platen. 2026).

A large part of this project consisted of fieldwork, as research, practice and part of the works themselves. The biggest challenge has been to find the best possible way to present all these different parts of the project, without taking from each other or confusing the audience. I believe, my goal as an artist should not be clarity, but rather show multitudes of insecurities and mystery. This balance, between clarity in presenting, and letting the works speak their own myths, proved harder than I first anticipated.

Trembling Matter was presented in two versions of spatial installation, each with a different aim. Firstly, the focus was on the materiality of each work. For the CRAFT! exam exhibition, seven works hanged from wood structures in a rectangular formation. The setting, a group exhibition with rather limited space, was not ideal for this, as some found it difficult to know how to enter the installation. In that presentation, no documentation of fieldwork was shown, as I wanted the works themselves to speak. The second presentation took place at the Konstfack Degree Exhibition. There, I wanted to make a more inviting installation, also showing the fieldwork and portability. Three works laid packed up on the floor, an integrated video showed the fieldwork and a blanket on the floor invite to sit down and listen to a soundscape in headphones. Four works were hanging, again on wooden structures, in the shape of a half circle and a sculpture stood at the center on the floor. This presentation felt more complete, yet it was hard to communicate the interconnectedness between material, place and body. Again, the setting of a group show also played in, making it difficult to lure the spectator into engagement.

The soundscape was part of the project from day one, and is something very dear to me. Now I see, that without a proper setting to incorporate sound, it risks to get lost. If the sound is played out loud, it has to be clear that it belongs to the installation itself. If headphones are used, a comfortable space without distractions is needed. The soundscape was produce in a limited edition of 10 vinyls, with unique screen-printed covers. From the start, I saw the sound as something accompanying the installation, but over time it became a work in its own right. A multidisciplinary practice requires courage to let work rest until the right moment. As an artist, you can expand endlessly, yet what is presented has to be right there in the moment; creating a feeling of presence and belonging to the work itself, no matter what feeling you are facing as an audience.

I have always dreamed of being a minimalist. But I have never been, and do not seem to become, not yet at least. Looking at my project from more of a distans now, I do believe that the phrase ”less is more” could be appropriate. In fact, the project could be broken apart into four projects, but which all build on the same methodology: research - fieldwork - speculation - making - fieldwork - presentation. One part is the 16th c tapestry which I recreated with 3D-printing, combining its motif with my own photographs; a new way to explore forgotten artworks as physical objects. The second is the canvases I fashioned myself; sewing old garments together, felting and the patchworks of leaves. They all have a certain melancholic yet dreamy tone, where image and material clearly supports each other. Thirdly, the paintings on found rugs,



Image 34. Installation view of *Trembling Matter* at the Konstfack degree exhibition (Gösta von Platen. 2026).

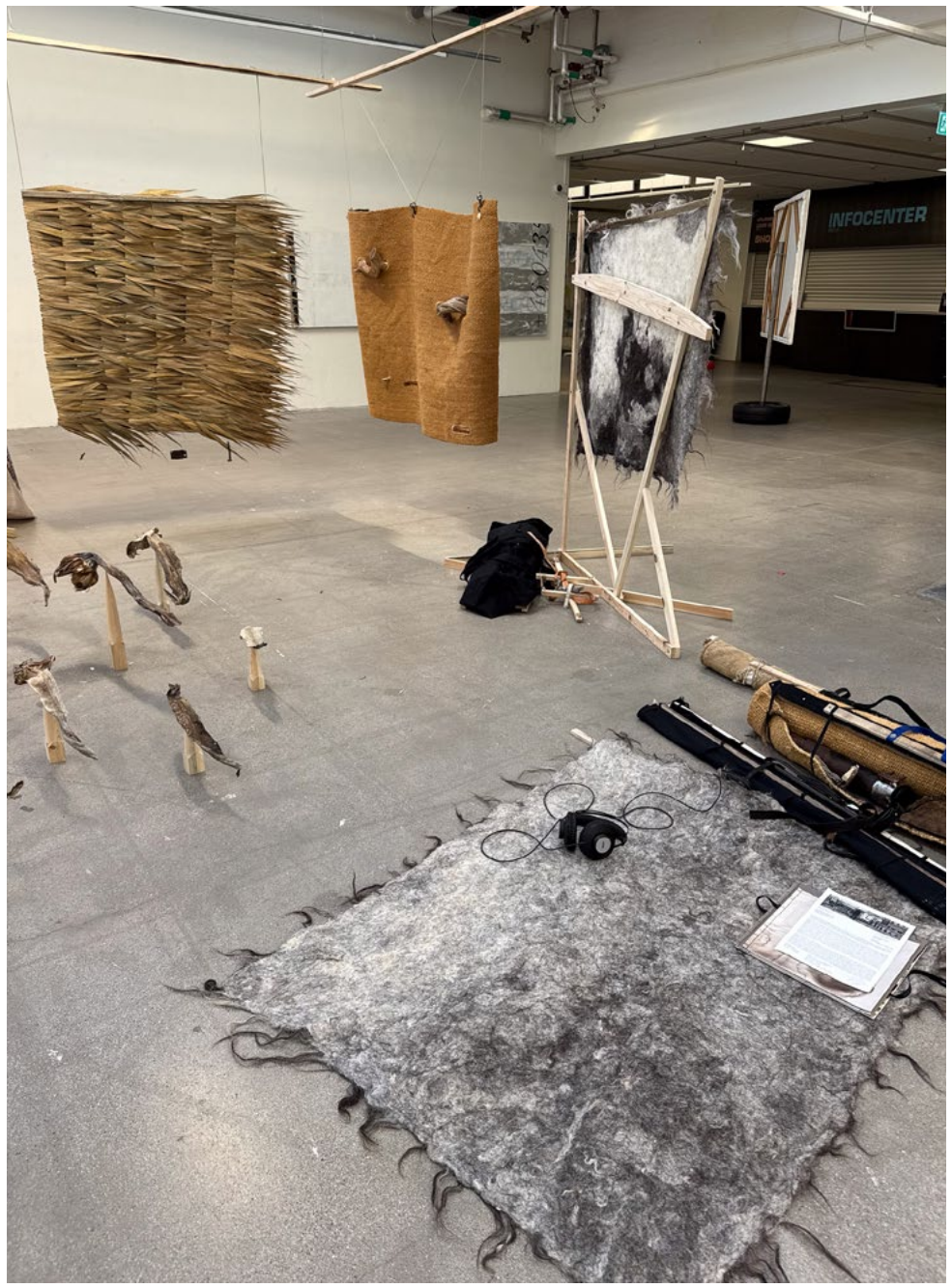


Image 35. Listening area at the at the Konstfack degree exhibition (Gösta von Platen. 2026).

which has a heavier bodily presence. Works in which I myself feel the most alive, where the spark inside is really present in the process of making. And the last one would be the sound piece. Identifying these different parts will surely help me combine them better or let them speak for themselves in future projects.

For now, my work exist in a Western centric space, which is important to acknowledge considering my topic. The extraction and displacement of materials, and people, does clearly not have the most impact on us living in the comforts of European standards. For that reason, the use of Anthropocene is perhaps not fully justified. I am not the one affected the most of the human impact on Earth, in fact I have a very comfortable and privileged life. Capitolocene would be more appropriate term, as it points at capitalistic systems being the cause rather than just humans in general. My artistic work lives within a capitalist system, where consumption, textile and market are feeding on each other. My background as a fashion designer set that path; it is up to me as an artist to use it the best way possible. My aim is not to give justice, but to tell a different story of how we can live together with the matter of our immediate surroundings.

This master project is only the beginning of a longer journey, to better understand how textiles has for centuries lived with us. To continue my career, I will most likely have to take on work in fashion design besides my artistic practice, which will inspire and give more depth to my continues research. One of the most fascinating discoveries I made during this project, was the idea of tapestry as textile environments around the 16th century. Today, we live in textile environments more than ever, but they are becoming disguised and displaced, with shorter and shorter life spans, as clothes, waste, house hold items, furniture and so on. I am not myself the most sustainably living person, but the more I explore my practice, the more I feel to be part of an organic system, which we are not in control of. One which I want to engage with, one where nature has a more significant role. A feeling I will hold on to, as I continue my research, fieldwork and making.

